

Jesus Is Our Covering and Hedge

First Corinthians 11, please. Nothing else will flow through me. Nothing else. This is pretty important to God, so I get to work on it tonight.

Hallelujah. At least I think I am.

Glory be to God.

If you want to put a marker, we will be over in Galatians again, the third chapter, and once again in Philippians, the second chapter. This time we will make it there, I am sure. There will be several other places.

Hallelujah.

It is just exciting to be alive. I feel better than I did when I was eighteen. What does a guy do about that? When I was eighteen, I had to take handfuls of aspirin for headaches. I do not have any of that anymore. I had an injured knee. I do not have that anymore. I had back problems for twenty years. I do not have that at all anymore.

Hallelujah.

I feel like I cannot go under for going over.

"You are obviously not moved by circumstances."

You got that right. Circumstances are another opportunity for testimony.

Say, "Go on, loser. Turn it up as bad as you can, because the worse you make it, the more I am going to milk the old cow for your defeat. I will tell it all over the world how I whipped you. Go on. Get as bad as you can, because when I get done whipping you, it will be in all of my messages. You would be real smart just to give me the money now with no testimony."

Hallelujah.

I have a big mouth, devil. Tape recorders, radio, I have a big mouth. That is what I am. Man, I am a preacher. I have a big mouth. So just drop it. Back out. Turn your back on me, and I will kick you.

Hallelujah.

I will make you pay for all of my friends who got defeated. Take on them, and I will take it out on you. I will add hours of agony to you, and I can do it because I am stubborn.

What makes me so hot? The blood of Jesus, you loser.

Hallelujah.

Nobody is your problem. They add to the problem, but they are not your problem. If you did not have a problem to add to, they could not multiply it.

Hallelujah.

Why are you opposing yourself just because the devil told you that you are something you are not, that you are crazy, dumb, going to lose, depressed, and going to kill yourself? Does that make what he said true?

Just because he says you are poor and uses your checkbook to prove it, who wants to listen to a dumb thing like that? The louder he yells about something, the harder I attack it.

I say, "That must be the furthest thing from the truth."

I am going to crawl in my closet, my private one, and worship Him for a long time. So go ahead and threaten me, devil. Who cares? You have been a liar since before the regeneration of the world. You fell before the garden scene. You were already cast out of heaven when you approached Adam. So you were dumb even before I was created in Adam.

If you have been dumb that long, I am taking nothing from you. Anybody who has practiced being dumb for over six thousand years does not deserve to counsel you.

You are just lucky God does not hang you up on an ignorance scale once in a while, just to weigh you out, if you listen to anything he says.

Can you imagine how ridiculous it is to take counsel about your business from a counselor who has lost for over six thousand years?

I have never heard anything so ignorant.

If he tells me I am going to lose, which he does, then just for spite's sake I stand there and tell him, "No, I am going to win, because the Word said it. I do not care whether it does or not. I am not listening to you. Anybody dumb enough to turn against God and turn into what you are, I am not listening to you."

I used to, but I am not going to listen to you anymore.

Make him show you his credentials.

"Where did you come from?"

"I came from heaven."

"Why are you not there anymore? Answer me truthfully now, you liar. Because you were thrown out. Where are you going? If you do not know, I can show you. Turn over to the book of Revelation."

He is going to lock you up and put you in chains for about a thousand years just to do some work on the earth. You cannot do a thing about it. He is going to put a big spiritual stone over you and chain you up. However He does it with spiritual chains, they are going to hold.

That is one thousand years of your future. Then you and the false prophet get to share the lake of fire. All the time I will be in heaven, in absolute and intimate fellowship with my Father.

Where are you going to be? Burning, burning, burning.

Where am I going to be? Glory, glory, glory.

Had enough? I am not going to sign your contract, devil. You can talk all night. I do not care. I will take equal time to whip you. You are a loser. I am not listening to you.

I will tell you where you are going after that: eternity locked up forever and ever. You do not have time, devil. You have eternity. You are stupid. You are dumb. But you can leave.

Since you know you have to leave, I am going to do it right now. I have two great big friends, great big friends. If you think you can stand up to my big friends on each side of me here, then God is going to come forth from my spirit where the Holy Ghost lives. You do not want to be around when He settles down over you. If I were you, I would think about departing while you have enough strength to depart with.

That was a prophecy. It was the exhortation out of a prophecy. It started coming through my spirit, so I gave it in the first person. But that was prophecy, exhortation, and comfort by the power of the Holy Spirit.

Amen.

Once in a while through prophecy, you get a glimpse of how God looks at the devil.

I do not have a problem. I just have answers. Hallelujah. If I do not know how to do something, I will find out how.

Are you ready? I cannot get away from this. I thought that prophecy would last another forty minutes, but it did not.

Let us begin with 1 Corinthians 11. The apostle Paul was talking about divine order and what happens when there is a breach in divine order.

Ecclesiastes 10 says that a man who digs a ditch will fall in it, and whoever breaks a hedge, a serpent will bite him. If a man breaches divine order, he is digging a ditch. He will fall in it. If he breaches divine order, there will be a gap in the hedge that surrounds him, just like a chink can be put into the armor of God.

He said to put on the armor so you could stand against the wiles of the devil. There is a hedge around you of divine order. If you dig a pit and put a breach in the hedge, the serpent will come through, just like if you run around with one of the pieces of armor off. The devil will come in

behind the armor, get on the inside of your operation, and try to kill you from the inside.

As you know, the first piece of armor was loins girded about with truth. Then there was the sword of the Spirit, which is the Word of God. That is the one you wield aggressively. But the loins girded about with truth is you standing behind the handle of the sword. That is your handling of the truth, your transformation to it.

If a man is a liar, exaggerator, misleader of truth, or lets lies stand in his presence, there is a chink in the armor. The devil likes to get behind it and then destroy you.

Just like a man who digs a pit will fall in it, and a breach in a hedge lets serpents crawl through and bite, Paul is talking about divine order here.

This is probably one of the most misunderstood chapters in the entire Word of God. The only reason I really understand it now is because it opened up Ephesians 5, and Ephesians 5 turned around and opened up 1 Corinthians 11 again until it went deeper and deeper.

There is protection in divine order.

Notice carefully what he says as he gives this outline for divine order:

Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of Christ.

Now I praise you, brethren, that ye remember me in all things, and keep the ordinances, as I delivered them to you.

As long as I follow Christ, you can follow me, because my actions will be of Him.

He says:

But I would have you know, that the head of every man is Christ;
and the head of the woman is the man;
and the head of Christ is God.

Another word for head there is covering. So let us read it with that:

The covering of every man is Christ.
The covering of the woman is the man.
The covering of Christ is God.

That is why he went on to say:

Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonoureth his head.

But every woman that prayeth or prophesieth with her head uncovered dishonoureth her head.

The head the man dishonors is Christ. It is very dishonoring to Christ when a man falls down on his position in Christ and allows a woman to cover him, that is, to provide for all of his needs.

It is not that this man was not prophesying and praying. He was fulfilling a ministry. But it is very dishonoring to Christ when a man lays down, receives his supply from a woman, and lets her cover him.

It is dishonoring because Christ is the head of the church and the Savior of the body. Another word for Savior is provider. Not only is He the covering of the church, He is the provider of the body.

For a man to let a woman cover him and supply his needs is a breach. It is an insult to Jesus Christ. It stands against everything He stands for as our covering and the supplier of our needs.

Did you notice that the man or woman is praying or prophesying with a breach in divine order? They are still praying and prophesying. They are fulfilling ministry. But as long as there is a breach in the hedge, those serpents are going to crawl through and make your life hell, just as that devil tried to put a thorn in Paul's flesh because he could not get to him.

He will try to get to you, your children, your wife, your husband. He will try to weaken your front lines and assault you because there is that kind of breach in your hedge.

God only requires that you fulfill the Word of God. You cannot live for somebody else. If your husband or wife will not be covered, rebels, and will not go with you, God does not cause you to stand in their place in judgment.

All you can do for another adult is believe for them, stand for them, walk where you are supposed to walk, and Jesus will make up the difference in your covering.

Hallelujah.

You cannot walk for somebody else. You can do what it says toward your children, but there is no adult you can walk in this for, no more than Adam could walk this walk for Eve or Eve for Adam.

Nevertheless, God is full of grace. These people were still prophesying and praying.

That is different from what you may esteem it to be. He linked prophesying and praying together as though these were two things people usually did. Anybody who had any degree of ministry and handled the Word usually prayed and prophesied.

In the early church, they did not have a Bible to flip open like you do right now. They did not have Ephesians and Colossians in a collected work in their laps. Paul would write to one church, another to the Ephesians, and another to this one or that one, but everybody did not have a

collected work. Many people could not read. That is who the scribes were: record keepers and readers.

The great church of God was full of apostles, prophets, teachers, and pastors. Those who operated in tremendous revelation knowledge were your prophets and apostles. The apostles were charged by God to set the foundation of the church. The prophets received revelation from God within that foundation and went from church to church, establishing them for the present hour in the mind of Christ.

These prophets would pray, and then they would prophesy, because praying, they would receive an answer to the mysteries they prayed. They would walk into a church, and if any prophet sitting by received something from God, the first one had already had his turn. The spirit of the prophet is subject to the prophet. Let him wait. Then the great mystery he received from God could be spoken to the church.

Understanding that, you can understand the statement in Corinthians. A man or woman praying and prophesying with their head covered or uncovered means they are not fulfilling the position Jesus created them for in divine order. They weaken the hedge and give the devil a chance to crawl through and weaken the church and family unit's chances of making it through unscathed.

I know some of you, not by your choice or doing or undoing, have had hell. Jesus knows that. Where anyone falls down, He steps in and is your covering. If you are not the one dishonoring Him by putting a breach in divine order and tearing a hole in the hedge, He covers you.

He was not talking about the custom of whether to wear a hat or not. The long or short hair was symbolic of being in submission to God and the woman to the man. But he said if there is contention about that, there is no such custom in the churches of God. So we cannot have contention over that.

He just wanted you to know what it all stood for.

He said, "Take a lesson from nature." Does the animal kingdom breach its role and switch roles? No. So take a lesson. Fortify yourself. Patch your hedge up. Strengthen it. Take your place in Christ.

Men, cover your families. Cover your wife.

Women, there is no dishonor in being created a woman, because we are absolutely equal with each other in spirit. There is neither male nor female. Absolutely equal with each other, as Jesus was equal with God but did not consider it robbery to take the form of a servant.

Where is the robbery? It is only in divine order so natural order can be fulfilled in the role He created you for. You are a woman because you were created a woman. We are men because we were created men. But in the spirit, every bit is equal and powerful in praying or prophesying.

Women, it should be a privilege to lay your head on a great big broad shoulder, close your eyes, and know you are being covered like Jesus loves the church.

"I do not have it that way."

Lay your head on Jesus' shoulder.

When should I work? Should I do this? Should I do that?

That is a multiple question. It has to do with your children, the ages of everything right on through to your career and your maturity. God has an answer for everything.

One thing you have to remember for sure: the divorce rate at fifty-three percent did not come overnight. That is because the last generation handled it wrong. The one before them handled it wrong. There is a spirit that came in and said, "You are being robbed."

Robbed of what? Did Jesus consider Himself robbed? If He had not humbled Himself to keep from breaching divine order, if He had not been found in fashion as a man and humbled Himself to the cross, you would not even be saved.

How is it robbery to fulfill the role you were created for?

If I were you, I would consider it an honor to be created a woman. The only thing he meant when he said the woman was in the image of the man is that God created the man first in His own image, and He created the woman in the image of the man by making variations in her. She was created to have the children. Do men have them? No. She was created to nurture the children after they were born. Can men do that? No. But men did go out and gather food for her while she nurtured the children.

There is no dishonor in God trusting you to be born a woman and fulfill that role, just as there is no dishonor to a man being trusted to fulfill the role he is filling.

Can I have a career? Can I work? If you can have a ministry and prophesy and pray, then you can also have a career, something God created you for. But in that, you have to make sure you are not breaching divine order with your children or with your husband.

Hallelujah.

Let us examine this a little bit deeper. I love these verses.

Let us look at the equality of men and women first. Where is the robbery?

My God, man. Maria Woodworth-Etter, Kathryn Kuhlman, Aimee Semple McPherson. These women set the world on fire. Where is the dishonor? They were prophesying and praying just like the men.

A lot of times the man cannot enter ministry because he cannot get enough people to want him to preach to support his family, so he wants his wife to support him. Breach, breach, breach.

It is not that they were not prophesying or praying.

Go to Galatians 3:26:

For ye are all the children of God by faith in Christ Jesus.

For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ.

There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither bond nor free, there is neither male nor female:

for ye are all one in Christ Jesus.

And if ye be Christ's, then are ye Abraham's seed, and heirs according to the promise.

This must be in the Spirit, because there certainly is male and female in the natural.

This answers why, when we get to heaven, there is neither male nor female in the sense of marriage. You will have femininity and masculinity, I am sure. But as far as marriage and those things are concerned, who is My brother, My sister, My mother, and My father? Jesus said, "Those that hear the Word of God and keep it."

The Sadducees, who did not believe in the resurrection, said a woman had seven husbands, they all had her, and she had no children by any of them. In heaven, since she had no children to link her with any of those husbands, which one will be her husband?

Jesus said, "You greatly err, because you do not know the Word of God." In heaven, do you think you will find your wife or husband and set up housekeeping like you had here? You are not going to do that. He said in heaven they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are as the angels of heaven.

We are all the family of God, brothers and sisters. That is why, in the Song of Solomon, when Jesus was telling the church how much He loved her, He said, "My sister, My spouse."

God set up this natural institution and had divine order to go with it. That is what we were created for. But there we become the family of God.

Will I know? Of course. We will be family. She will be the mother of your eternal offspring. You will be the father. But you have to understand that the whole human race is linked together as brothers and sisters in Adam, and God is glad to have you home.

So he says there is neither male nor female, absolute equality in God. Only in the natural did He have a divine order and create us for respective roles to fulfill the will of God.

Let us take it a little further. Go to Philippians 2:2:

Fulfil ye my joy, that ye be likeminded, having the same love, being of one accord, of one mind.

Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves.

Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.

That means look to somebody else's needs as something to meet, even more important than yours.

Then he says something incredible:

Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus:

Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God:

But made Himself of no reputation, and took upon Him the form of a servant, and was made in the likeness of men:

And being found in fashion as a man, He humbled Himself, and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross.

Wherefore God also hath highly exalted Him, and given Him a name which is above every name:

That at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth.

Jesus subjected all of this unto God as His covering.

Jesus, being in the form of God, already in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God. If you are already in the form of God, that means you are God. You could not have the form of God and not be God.

So where would the robbery be?

This is why we have missed what is in these verses. Jesus was in the form of God and coequal in every way with God. Yet He did not consider it robbery to find Himself humbled in the fashion of a man, submitting Himself to the death of the cross. Because He did this, He was exalted above every name.

What Paul was talking about was not that Jesus considered Himself equal with God and that was not robbery. The robbery was considered when He took on the form of a servant, obedient to the death of the cross. Though He was in the form of God, He did not consider Himself robbed because He took the form of a servant.

In His glorified humanity, He was exalted to the right hand of the Father as Lord, Advocate, and High Priest over the entire church. But there is still divine order here. The head of every man is Christ, the head of the woman is the man, and the head of Christ in His glorified humanity as High Priest of the church is God.

Yet in the Spirit, He is still the second member of the Godhead and equal with God. In His glorified humanity, He subjected Himself under God, who is covering Jesus Christ. In all of this, He does not consider Himself robbed, even though He is tri-equal with the other two members of the Godhead.

"I would like you to prove that."

Do not say that when I have twenty minutes.

Hallelujah.

Go to Genesis 1:1 and put your finger in John 1:1. We will go ahead and prove it, and then I will stop.

Follow me very closely now. How equal was Jesus with God? How equal are we with each other? What roles of servants has He asked us to play?

If a man uses his position to force his wife into serving his flesh, he has breached divine order. He has taken her out of equal status with him, and it is a breach.

When Peter said to dwell with your wife according to knowledge as the weaker vessel, he meant you know the divine order God gave you, so dwell with her according to that knowledge and do not force her into serving your flesh. The weaker vessel means, passing in review, that our spirits are created the same. We have equality in God. Only the outer part of the clay jar was created different for different roles.

When a woman is forced into the workplace and cannot cover her family like she would like to, then Christ is your covering. But you have to fellowship with Him and let Him repair the breach. Do not let the devil make you masculine. You are not masculine. You are a woman.

Hallelujah.

Genesis 1:1:

In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

When we use the terminology God, we are speaking of the three members of the Godhead, who are one in essence. The three members of the Godhead have all the attributes that make them one in essence, although they are three persons.

When you say, "I love You, God," you are talking to all three of Them: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost as we know Them now.

Before Jesus was born, the Father was known as the mighty Jehovah. Jesus was known as the Logos, the Word. The Holy Spirit has always been known as the Spirit of God, or the Holy Spirit.

When you say, "I love You, Father," you are talking to Him whom the Jews referred to as Jehovah. When you are talking to the mighty Logos, whom we now love and know as Jesus, you are talking to the second person of the Godhead. It is okay to say, "I love You and respect You, Holy Spirit." You are talking to the third member.

In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth. The three members of the Godhead, acting as one, created everything that is.

When could the beginning possibly be? If there has never been a time God has not existed, when was there a beginning? God lives outside this timeline. Time is His creation. He does not have any. There is no time with Him.

The beginning here is the beginning of everything you and I understand to exist: this natural universe and everything in it. Before stars, heaven, interstellar space, the Milky Way, the universe, and the great void, God was already here forever.

In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, God created it.

Verse 2 says:

And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep.
And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.

We do not know how long it was between the creation of the universe and the regeneration when the Spirit moved on the face of the deep. God, acting as one, created the heavens and the earth. Then the Holy Spirit came and did the work of regeneration and caused this earth to become habitable for a human being.

Hallelujah.

When we get to John 1, he goes into more detail and gives the respective roles each member of the Godhead played in creation, which proves the equality Jesus Christ, the Word, had with the Father.

If He did not consider it robbery, being equal with God, to become a servant, then since we are one in spirit and there is neither male nor female, why would either one of us consider ourselves robbed for being created for the role we were created for?

John 1:1 says:

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

John is quoting Genesis now. In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, was the Logos, the collective Word of God, the thoughts of God.

The second person in the Godhead was the One chosen to pass over the breach between man and God. He was the Word of God. "Philip, have you seen Me? You have seen the Father." He was the communication. He was sent from heaven by election to restore the breach between man and God.

He is the thoughts of God. He is God's will for us. He is the Word of God. He is everything God is.

In the beginning was the mighty Logos, the second person in the Godhead before we ever knew Him as Christ. The Logos was with God. The word God there covers the other two members of the Godhead. He was with mighty Jehovah and with the Holy Ghost, and He was God.

In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, was the mighty Word. He was with the other two members of the Godhead, and He was God.

He stood tri-equal with the other two members of the Godhead.

Have you ever thought of this? How can you be a Son without having a beginning? Every son is born of someone. If He existed forever, how could He be a Son? Because a son has to have a beginning.

When He told the Pharisees, "Abraham saw My day and was glad," they said, "You are not yet fifty years old. How can You say Abraham saw Your day?"

He said, "Before Abraham was, I am." He switched to His deity. His deity never had a beginning and never had an end. His humanity had a beginning and will never have an end.

You will never be equal with His deity. That part was never given to you. But you will be equal with His humanity. He is the glorified Brother of every sister and brother in the body of Christ. He is not ashamed to be called my Brother in His glorified humanity.

John says:

The same was in the beginning with God.

All things were made by Him; and without Him was not any thing made that was made.

The second person in the Godhead created the substance this universe hangs on. All things were made by Him. Without Him was not one single thing made that was made.

Verse 10 says:

He was in the world, and the world was made by Him, and the world knew Him not.

He held the molecular structure in His deity of the cross He was crucified on. He had the wisdom in His deity for that molecular structure. Yet when He was tried in your place, He opened not His mouth. As a sheep before her shearers is dumb, He opened not His mouth.

He was not guilty, but He was guilty in your place. So He did not have the right to defend Himself. When they accused Him and later crucified Him, He never opened His mouth and gave a defense for every accusation because He was guilty in your place.

Even though He had the answer for everything and knew the formula for the molecular structure of the cross, He would not open His mouth and give the wisdom.

Why? So that in any business deal, any situation at the chief places of concourse, the business intersections of the city, when you need wisdom, you can open your mouth. Wisdom cries and waves red flags.

When the devil indicts you and starts putting you on trial for the trial Jesus was already condemned in, He refused to open His mouth in substitution for you. He knew everything, so you can rear back and open your mouth during the indictment with the wisdom He would not give, because He died in your place.

Hallelujah.

Jesus was already condemned, judged, tried, and executed for my failure. He would not defend Himself, and then He handed His defense to me. He would not open His mouth so I could, and I am getting out of this.

Hallelujah.

The tri-equal Godhead sat down in divine decree and discussed the creation of the universe and man. The One we know as mighty Jehovah, now our Father, had the privilege of laying the whole plan out. The second person in the Godhead stood up and said, "I will create everything You have planned."

The Holy Spirit stood up and said, "There is one role left for Me. You planned it, You created it, and I will be the Regenerator. When man falls, I will regenerate their spirit. When You decide which galaxy they will live on, I will move upon the face of the deep. I will be the power. I will move in them. I will be the One who comes and takes up My abode in them and represents them to the Godhead."

Jesus redeems them, and the Holy Spirit represents them as a lawyer. When He gets it right, Jesus turns to the Father and says, "Turn them loose."

Hallelujah.

Since God foresaw what the devil would do and planned for all of this, He brought a prayer language that encompasses everything heard in heaven for each person's life, plan, and call. When we do not know where we are going, we begin to pray. Romans 8:27 begins to operate, and all things begin to work together for good to them who love God and are called according to His purpose.

Whom He foreknew, He predestined to be conformed to His image. How shall He who spared not His own Son not freely with Him give us all things?

Who is he that condemneth? Who has the power to condemn you if it is God who justifies? I am convinced that since God did not spare Jesus but delivered Him up for us all, neither life nor death, things present nor things to come, height nor depth, nor any creature can separate me from the love and plan of God when I am securely placed into the hands of the Godhead.

Think about this. Jesus was Creator, and He did not consider Himself robbed. "I will redeem these people. I will deliver everything back to You, both in heaven and earth and under the earth. I will sit down at Your right hand, and in My humanity I will be these people's Priest. I have not been robbed."

You have not been robbed. You are neither male nor female in Christ, but all one. Only in the respective roles Jesus was created for, I was created for, and you were created for does God ask us to walk.

God can assure you that His divine order works better than anything you can organize. It stops the devil.

Put the hedge up. Put the hedge up and become a servant.

Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus.

He did not consider Himself robbed.

To think we get to spend so much time with Him. There is a place in the Holy Spirit, when you break through from glory to glory, you have no idea what you are doing during that hour. You have no idea what things you are moving, creating, restoring, and establishing in those two or three hours you spend in earnest prayer and worshipping God like there is nobody else in the room.

You would get your appointment book out and ask, "What is Your third hour, God? I can let that go, can't I?"

Yes.

For as you continue to pray apart from Me, hear what the Spirit says and follow His leadership. If you do what I tell you, and to the rest of you, you will enter into a place, a place of prayer, a place of holiness. For suddenly I will come, and I will come as suddenly as I came to the temple. I will come suddenly, and from that day you shall see My glory poured out upon this foundation.

Hear what the Spirit would say, and follow closely the instructions. All that I tell you to do, do with all of your might, and I shall come suddenly, saith the Lord.

Let me tell you something. There are a lot of people who walked in the flesh, who took the avenue of the flesh to do things, who are going to be hurting in the years to come. Those who have abundance but walked in the flesh are going to lose it. There is going to be a switch.

If I were you, I would pull my old saddle off the fence, go on and get it in there, put it on the bronco, and ride that thing into the ground.

Hallelujah.

Glory be to God.